

Scheme of Assistance to State Scheduled Castes Development Corporations (SCDCs)

Prepared summary based on official Government of India information

Important note: This is a newly prepared informational summary, not a replacement for the Government's original notification or revised guidelines. The official document identified is titled "Scheme of Assistance to State Scheduled Castes Development Corporation (SCDCs) – Revised Guidelines 2017-18." Applicants should verify current rules with the concerned State SCDC.

1. About the Scheme

The scheme is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme intended to support State Scheduled Castes Development Corporations. It was introduced in 1978-79 to help mobilise finance and promote economic development among eligible Scheduled Caste families, particularly those requiring support for self-employment and livelihood activities.

2. Main Objectives

- Identify eligible Scheduled Caste families and motivate them to undertake viable economic activities.
- Sponsor proposals to financial institutions for credit support.
- Provide margin-money assistance, loans and subsidy support, subject to applicable rules.
- Reduce repayment burden and connect beneficiaries with other poverty-alleviation programmes.

3. Financial Pattern

The official scheme describes equity participation by the Central Government and State Governments in the ratio of 49:51. The Central share is provided to State SCDCs, while the State share is contributed by the concerned State Government. Project cost norms and detailed assistance conditions may be determined by the State Government and the concerned SCDC.

4. Major Activities Covered

Employment-oriented activities may include:

- Agriculture and allied activities, including minor irrigation
- Small-scale industry and manufacturing
- Transport activities
- Trade and service-sector businesses

Other economically viable activities may be considered according to State-level rules and the beneficiary's qualifications, experience and local opportunities.

5. Assistance Mechanism

SCDCs generally act as facilitators and channelising agencies. They may coordinate with banks, the National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation (NSFDC), and other financial institutions. Assistance can involve term loans, margin money, subsidy, training or other support, depending on the applicable State scheme.

6. Eligibility

The official material identifies Scheduled Caste persons/families as the target group. The revised guidelines and State-level procedures determine detailed eligibility, income limits, residence requirements, project viability, documentation and other conditions. Applicants should contact the concerned State SCDC for the current criteria.

7. How to Apply

1. Contact the State Scheduled Castes Development Corporation or its district office.
2. Ask for the current self-employment / economic development scheme application form.
3. Prepare a project proposal and required documents.
4. Submit the application through the prescribed channel.
5. The SCDC and linked financial institution will assess eligibility, project viability and loan support.
6. If approved, assistance is released according to the applicable rules.

8. Common Documents (may vary by State)

- Caste certificate
- Aadhaar or other identity proof
- Residence / domicile proof
- Income certificate, where required
- Bank account details
- Photographs
- Project report or business plan
- Educational / technical / experience documents, where relevant
- Quotations or estimates for equipment/assets, where relevant

9. Official Source

Department of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India: Scheme of Assistance to Scheduled Castes Development Corporations (SCDCs). Official scheme page: <https://socialjustice.gov.in/schemes/36>

Official revised-guidelines PDF: <https://socialjustice.gov.in/writereaddata/UploadFile/scdcorp09082019.pdf>

10. Disclaimer

Rules, subsidy amounts, income limits, project ceilings, interest rates, documents and application procedures may change or differ by State. This summary is for educational and website-project use. For an actual application, rely on the latest notification issued by the concerned State SCDC and the Government of India.